

Addison J. Wu

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addisonwu05.github.io

Citizenship: USA, Canada

Education

2023 – 2027 **Princeton University**

BSE in Computer Science, Minor in Mathematics – GPA: 3.98/4.00

Honors: Exemplary Independent Work Award, Shapiro Prize for Academic Excellence, NeurIPS Scholar Award, Tau Beta Pi, Sigma Xi (Associate)

Coursework: addisonwu05.github.io/academics

Experience

2026 – [Center for AI Safety](#)

Research Intern, advised by Mantas Mazeika, Dan Hendrycks

2024 – [Princeton Language and Intelligence](#)

*Undergraduate Researcher, advised by Tom Griffiths, Zhuang Liu
Model behavior, safety, post-training, evaluation*

2023 – 2025 [Multi-Physics Interaction Lab](#), University of Waterloo

*Undergraduate Researcher, advised by Jean-Pierre Hickey
Neural networks for atmospheric infrasound localization*

Publications

 [Google Scholar](#) * → Equal contribution

Conference/Journal Papers

- Large Language Models Develop Novel Social Biases Through Adaptive Exploration**
Addison J. Wu*, Ryan Liu*, Xuechunzi Bai, Thomas L. Griffiths
*ICML 2026 **Oral**. SPSP 2026 *Invited Symposia Talk** [\[link\]](#)
- Ads in AI Chatbots? An Analysis of How Large Language Models Navigate Conflicts of Interest**
Addison J. Wu*, Ryan Liu*, Shuyue Stella Li, Yulia Tsvetkov, Thomas L. Griffiths
COLM 2026 [\[link\]](#)
- Are Large Language Models Sensitive to the Motives Behind Communication?**
Addison J. Wu*, Ryan Liu*, Kerem Oktar*, Theodore R. Sumers, Thomas L. Griffiths
*NeurIPS 2025. PragLM @ COLM 2025 **Oral*** [\[link\]](#)
- Mind Your Step (by Step): Chain-of-Thought can Reduce Performance on Tasks where Thinking Makes Humans Worse**
Ryan Liu*, Jiayi Geng*, Addison J. Wu, Ilia Sucholutsky, Tania Lombrozo, Thomas L. Griffiths
ICML 2025 [\[link\]](#)
- Toward a Neural Network-Based Approach for Improved Atmospheric Infrasound Localization**
Addison J. Wu, Arnav Joshi, Jean-Pierre Hickey
IEEE Access, 2025 [\[link\]](#)

Workshop Papers

- Where did the ambiguity go? Examining how multimodal models interpret polysemous words**
Jasin Cekinmez*, Addison J. Wu*, Raja Marjeh, Thomas L. Griffiths
*SciFM @ COLM 2026 **Oral*** [\[link\]](#)

2. **Quantifying Empirical Compute-Supervision Tradeoffs in RLVR**
Ryo Mitsuhashi*, Patrick Chen*, Isabelle Tseng*, Jasin Cekinmez*, **Addison J. Wu***
Combining Theory and Benchmarks @ ICML 2026 [\[link\]](#)
3. **OccludeBench: Can VLMs See the Hint?**
Jasin Cekinmez*, **Addison J. Wu***, Ryo Mitsuhashi*, Linrong Cai, Xingyu Fu, Zhuang Liu
Computer Vision in the Wild @ CVPR 2026 [\[link\]](#)
4. **Query Timing Produces Opposite Positional Biases Between LLMs and Humans**
Jasin Cekinmez*, **Addison J. Wu***, Thomas L. Griffiths
ICBINB @ ICLR 2026 *Entropic Paper Award* [\[link\]](#)

Preprints

1. **SportD: Can VLMs Physically Strategize?**
Jasin Cekinmez*, **Addison J. Wu***, Haotian Xia, Akshaya Bharadhwaj, Anay Putty, Anirudh Ravishankar, Jaewoong Lee, Jinglin Xiao, Kyumin Andrew Shim, Mishika Ahuja, Nisarga Patil, Leo Liu, Zhuohan Liu, Weining Shen
arXiv preprint, 2026 [\[link\]](#)
2. **Guess the Unified Model: How Much Can We Recover from Generated Images?**
Jasin Cekinmez*, Ryo Mitsuhashi*, **Addison J. Wu***, Yida Yin
arXiv preprint, 2026 [\[link\]](#)

Policy Citations

- | | |
|------|---|
| 2026 | U.S. Senate Judiciary Committee, Subcommittee on Crime and Counterterrorism
<i>Ads in AI Chatbots?</i> cited in the written testimony of Lindsay Owens, Groundwork Collaborative, <i>Your Data, Their Profit: The Consumer Cost of AI Surveillance Pricing</i> |
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Press Coverage

- | | |
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| 2026 | Forbes, AI Hiring Tools Don't Just Learn Bias, AI Forms New Biases Of Its Own |
| 2026 | Arizona's Family, AI can invent its own hiring bias — and it happens fast, new study finds |
| 2026 | MIT Technology Review, AI is more likely than humans to form biases when hiring |
| 2026 | Indian Express, Your AI 'assistant' is making money for someone else, you are the one paying. Here's exactly how |
| 2026 | Hacks/Hackers, New research: 18 of 23 AI models prioritize company revenue over users when ads enter the picture |
| 2025 | The Information, Where LLMs Are Falling Short [full text] |

Invited and Contributed Talks

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| 2026 | ICML 2026 Oral
<i>Large Language Models Develop Novel Social Biases Through Adaptive Exploration</i> |
| 2026 | SPSP 2026 Invited Symposia
<i>Large Language Models Develop Novel Social Biases Through Adaptive Exploration</i>
(presented by co-author X. Bai) |
| 2025 | UCLA NLP Seminar Series
<i>Are Large Language Models Sensitive to the Motives Behind Communication?</i>
<i>Large Language Models Develop Novel Social Biases Through Adaptive Exploration</i>
(presented by co-first author R. Liu) |
| 2025 | PragLM @ COLM 2025
<i>Are Large Language Models Sensitive to the Motives Behind Communication?</i> |

Teaching Experience

2024–2025 Undergraduate Course Assistant, Algorithms and Data Structures (COS 226)
Fall 2024, Spring 2025, Fall 2025

Professional Services

2026 Reviewer, NeurIPS 2026
2025 Reviewer, MTI-LLM @ NeurIPS 2025